

9. Source: Meeting with the local head of police in Beta Town during a meeting widely attended by locals

Report: Meeting with Local Police Chief on HfA Staff Situation

The Health for All (HfA) delegation recently met with the local police chief to discuss the ongoing staff situation. During the meeting, the chief expressed his discontent, firmly placing the responsibility for the situation on HfA.

The police chief emphasized the importance of HfA modifying its policy and continuing minimal health services at the local hospital for the time being. While the police are committed to facilitating the safe release of the detained staff, the chief noted that a resolution seems improbable amidst the current labor disagreements involving local authorities, hospital personnel, and tribal leaders. He emphasized the importance of working with tribal leadership, which was supported by tribe members in attendance.

Although the staff is deemed safe within their residence and have even been permitted to venture out for essential supplies, the chief warned of a potentially deteriorating situation if HfA fails to negotiate swiftly with the tribal leaders. He was clear in stating the police will not intervene, fearing potential violent clashes with the tribespeople.

The chief's recommendation to the visiting HfA team from Geneva is to engage in a constructive dialogue with the tribal leaders. Once an agreement on the health services is reached, the police will step in to restore peace.